“If I had enough faith, God would heal me.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

Some teachers and friends say that healing depends on the size of our faith. When healing does not come, guilt and doubt pile on top of illness.

What Scripture teaches

Jesus responded to faith that was weak: the father cried, “I do believe; help my unbelief!” and Jesus healed his son (Mark 9:24). Paul prayed three times about his thorn, and God said, “My grace is sufficient for you, for My power is perfected in weakness.” Timothy had frequent ailments, Epaphroditus was sick “nearly unto death,” and Paul left Trophimus “sick in Miletus.” Scripture treats illness as part of life, not as a faith failure. God can and does heal, and He does so by His wisdom, not by a formula.

> *“Immediately the boy’s father cried out, ‘I do believe; help my unbelief!’”* (Mark 9:24).

Also see

> “But He said to me, ‘My grace is sufficient for you, for My power is perfected in weakness.’ Therefore I will boast all the more gladly in my weaknesses, so that the power of Christ may rest on me” (2 Corinthians 12:9).

> “Erastus has remained at Corinth, and Trophimus I left sick in Miletus” (2 Timothy 4:20).

> “He was sick indeed, nearly unto death. But God had mercy on him, and not only on him but also on me, to spare me sorrow upon sorrow” (Philippians 2:27).

> “The LORD will sustain him on his bed of illness and restore him from his bed of sickness” (Psalm 41:3).

Common self-statements

- My faith is too small.
- God is waiting for me to believe more.
- It is my fault I am not healed.
- Real faith always heals.
- I am blocking my own healing.
- I must try harder.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing healing is either by faith or never.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that I will stay sick.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling unhealed and concluding that my faith is weak.
- Labeling: Calling myself faithless.

Challenging questions

- Who taught me that healing depends on faith?
- What did Jesus do with weak faith?
- What did Paul and others do when healing did not come?
- What does grace look like in my situation?

- How can I trust God without a guarantee?
- What care can I receive in the meantime?

Truth summary

> My healing does not depend on the size of my faith. God hears even weak faith, and His grace is sufficient. I can ask for healing, receive medical care, and trust Him with the outcome.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Faith
- Sickness
- Guilt/Shame
- Prayer, Answers to
- Suffering

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Divorce
- Forgive/Forgiveness

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Praise You in This Storm — Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham
Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

I Am Not Alone — Kari Jobe
God's companionship remains through darkness, weakness, and uncertainty.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "If I had enough faith, God would heal me"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"If I had enough faith, God would heal me." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Who taught me that healing depends on faith?
- ☐ What did Jesus do with weak faith?
- ☐ What did Paul and others do when healing did not come?
- ☐ What does grace look like in my situation?
- ☐ How can I trust God without a guarantee?
- ☐ What care can I receive in the meantime?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ Jesus hears "help my unbelief."
- ☐ His grace is sufficient.
- ☐ Paul's friends were sick too.
- ☐ Illness is not faith failure.
- ☐ I can ask for healing.
- ☐ I can trust God with the outcome.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Mark 9:24
  "Immediately the boy's father cried out, 'I do believe; help my unbelief!'"
- ☐ 2 Corinthians 12:9
  "But He said to me, 'My grace is sufficient for you, for My power is perfected in weakness.' Therefore I will boast all the more gladly in my weaknesses, so that the power of Christ may rest on me."
- ☐ 2 Timothy 4:20
  "Erastus has remained at Corinth, and Trophimus I left sick in Miletus."

A verse I found myself: _____

_____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Trust, not formula: Each week, note one prayer and one act of trust.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Mark 9:24 becomes: "Sarah can write: "Jesus hears even weak faith, and His grace is enough.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Faith" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).

- [ ] Read Mark 9:14–29. Notice Jesus' response to weak faith.
- [ ] Pray honestly. Ask for healing and grace.
- [ ] Receive care. Medical treatment and prayer support.
- [ ] Let go of blame. Talk with a pastor if guilt persists.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "If I had enough faith, God would heal me": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Trust, not formula
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~If I had enough faith, God would heal me.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I believe; help my unbelief. Heal as You see fit, and give me grace in the meantime. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

BIOLOGICAL/PHYSICAL FALSE BELIEF #67 · HEALING AND FAITH

“God doesn't hear my prayers, or He would have taken this away.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

After praying for months or years for relief, silence can feel like rejection. Some conclude that God is not listening or does not care.

What Scripture teaches

Paul prayed three times and received a “no” with a better promise: “My grace is sufficient for you.” “The Spirit helps us in our weakness. For we do not know how we ought to pray, but the Spirit Himself intercedes for us with groans too deep for words.” Jesus prayed in Gethsemane, “Yet not My will, but Yours be done” (Luke 22:42). “He has not despised or detested the torment of the afflicted… but has attended to his cry for help.” God hears every prayer. His answers are sometimes “wait,” “no,” or “here is strength instead.”

> *“For He has not despised or detested the torment of the afflicted. He has not hidden His face from him, but has attended to his cry for help”* (Psalm 22:24).

Also see

> “In the same way, the Spirit helps us in our weakness. For we do not know how we ought to pray, but the Spirit Himself intercedes for us with groans too deep for words” (Romans 8:26).

> “But He said to me, ‘My grace is sufficient for you, for My power is perfected in weakness.’ Therefore I will boast all the more gladly in my weaknesses, so that the power of Christ may rest on me” (2 Corinthians 12:9).

> “‘For My thoughts are not your thoughts, neither are your ways My ways,’ declares the LORD. ‘For as the heavens are higher than the earth, so My ways are higher than your ways and My thoughts than your thoughts.’” (Isaiah 55:8–9).

> “The righteous cry out, and the LORD hears; He delivers them from all their troubles” (Psalm 34:17).

Common self-statements

- God ignores me.
- My prayers bounce off the ceiling.
- He answers others, not me.
- He could heal me if He wanted.
- Prayer is pointless.
- God does not care.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing God either answers my way or does not hear.
- Fortune telling: Predicting no answer ever.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling unheard and concluding that He is not listening.
- Labeling: Calling my prayers useless.

Challenging questions

- What have I prayed for, and how long?
- What has God provided that I did not ask for?

- What do Paul and Jesus teach about unanswered prayer?
- How does the Spirit help me pray?
- What would trust look like if the answer is “not now” or “no”?
- Who can pray with me?

Truth summary

> God hears every prayer, even when He does not give the answer I ask for. He may give grace, strength, or a different path. I can keep praying and trust His care.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Prayer, Answers to
- Prayer, How to
- Faith
- Suffering
- Trust

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Divorce
- Forgive/Forgiveness

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God’s care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Praise You in This Storm — Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham
Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

I Am Not Alone — Kari Jobe
God’s companionship remains through darkness, weakness, and uncertainty.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: “If I truly believed God’s truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?”

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "God doesn't hear my prayers, or He would have taken this away"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"God doesn't hear my prayers, or He would have taken this away." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What have I prayed for, and how long?
- ☐ What has God provided that I did not ask for?
- ☐ What do Paul and Jesus teach about unanswered prayer?
- ☐ How does the Spirit help me pray?
- ☐ What would trust look like if the answer is "not now" or "no"?
- ☐ Who can pray with me?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ God hears the afflicted.
- ☐ The Spirit helps me pray.
- ☐ His grace is sufficient.
- ☐ His ways are higher.
- ☐ I can keep praying.
- ☐ Others can pray with me.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Psalm 22:24
  "For He has not despised or detested the torment of the afflicted. He has not hidden His face from him, but has attended to his cry for help."
- ☐ Romans 8:26
  "In the same way, the Spirit helps us in our weakness. For we do not know how we ought to pray, but the Spirit Himself intercedes for us with groans too deep for words."
- ☐ 2 Corinthians 12:9
  "But He said to me, 'My grace is sufficient for you, for My power is perfected in weakness.' Therefore I will boast all the more gladly in my weaknesses, so that the power of Christ may rest on me."

A verse I found myself: _____

_____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Still praying: Each week, note one prayer and one provision.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Psalm 22:24 becomes: "Sarah can write: "God hears my cry for help.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Prayer, Answers to" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).

- [ ] Keep a prayer journal. Note requests and unexpected blessings.
- [ ] Ask others to pray. Share with a friend.
- [ ] Pray honestly. Say what you feel.
- [ ] Read Romans 8:26. Rest in the Spirit's help.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "God doesn't hear my prayers, or He would have taken this away": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Still praying
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~God doesn't hear my prayers, or He would have taken this away.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I have prayed and still hurt. Hear me, help me in my weakness, and give me trust to wait for Your answer. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

BIOLOGICAL/PHYSICAL FALSE BELIEF #68 · HEALING AND FAITH

“Needing medication means my faith is weak.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

Some believers are taught that faith and medicine are opposed. Taking pills can then feel like a lack of trust. Guilt sometimes leads people to stop treatment.

What Scripture teaches

Jesus said, “It is not the healthy who need a doctor, but the sick.” Paul counseled Timothy to take a little wine for his stomach and frequent ailments. Luke was a physician, and Paul called him “beloved.” The good Samaritan used oil and wine for wounds. “The prayer offered in faith will restore the one who is sick” (James 5:15), and elders are told to pray and anoint with oil, an ancient medicinal practice. God works through prayer and through doctors and medicine. Using both is wise.

> *“Jesus answered, ‘It is not the healthy who need a doctor, but the sick.’”* (Luke 5:31).

Also see

> “Stop drinking only water and use a little wine instead, because of your stomach and your frequent ailments” (1 Timothy 5:23).

> “Luke, the beloved physician, and Demas send you greetings” (Colossians 4:14).

> “Is any one of you sick? He should call the elders of the church to pray over him and anoint him with oil in the name of the Lord” (James 5:14).

> “Plans fail for lack of counsel, but with many advisers they succeed” (Proverbs 15:22).

Common self-statements

- A strong believer would trust God alone.
- Medicine shows I doubt God.
- I am cheating on faith.
- If God is my healer, I should not need pills.
- Others are healed by faith alone.
- I feel guilty taking it.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing I must choose either faith or medicine.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that God will withdraw if I use medicine.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling guilty and concluding my faith is weak.
- Labeling: Calling myself faithless.

Challenging questions

- Where did I learn to set faith against medicine?
- What does Scripture say about doctors and remedies?
- Can I thank God for the medicine He provides?
- What would my doctor advise?

- Who can pray with me as I continue treatment?
- What peace could I have in using both?

Truth summary

> Faith and medicine work together. God heals through many means, and using medicine wisely is an act of trust and stewardship. I can pray and take my treatment with thanks.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Therapy
- Faith
- Sickness
- Wisdom
- Guilt/Shame

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Divorce
- Self-Esteem, Low

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Already There — Casting Crowns
God's perspective extends beyond what we can currently understand.

Living Hope — Phil Wickham
Christ's resurrection and forgiveness provide hope beyond sin and death.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "Needing medication means my faith is weak"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"Needing medication means my faith is weak." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Where did I learn to set faith against medicine?
- ☐ What does Scripture say about doctors and remedies?
- ☐ Can I thank God for the medicine He provides?
- ☐ What would my doctor advise?
- ☐ Who can pray with me as I continue treatment?
- ☐ What peace could I have in using both?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ The sick need a doctor.
- ☐ Luke was a beloved physician.
- ☐ Prayer and medicine go together.
- ☐ God works through many means.
- ☐ I can give thanks for my treatment.
- ☐ I will follow my doctor's advice.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Luke 5:31
  "Jesus answered, 'It is not the healthy who need a doctor, but the sick.'"
- ☐ 1 Timothy 5:23
  "Stop drinking only water and use a little wine instead, because of your stomach and your frequent ailments."
- ☐ Colossians 4:14
  "Luke, the beloved physician, and Demas send you greetings."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- ☐ Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- ☐ Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ Faith and care together: Each week, thank God as you take your treatment.
- ☐ My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Luke 5:31 becomes: "Sarah can write: "The sick need a doctor, and God uses many means to heal.""
- ☐ Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ Reading: The "Therapy" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).

- ☐ Pray with each dose. Say a short thanks.
- ☐ Talk with your pastor and doctor. Seek harmony.
- ☐ Read Luke 5:31. Remember who needs a doctor.
- ☐ Do not stop abruptly. Make changes only with your doctor.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "Needing medication means my faith is weak": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Faith and care together
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~Needing medication means my faith is weak.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, thank You for medicine and doctors. Free me from guilt, and help me trust You as I use the means You provide. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

BIOLOGICAL/PHYSICAL FALSE BELIEF #69 · HEALING AND FAITH

“Christians shouldn't get depressed or anxious.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

Many churches speak of joy and peace without space for struggle. Believers who feel depressed or anxious may think they are failing, or that they are not truly saved.

What Scripture teaches

David wrote, “Why are you downcast, O my soul? Why the unease within me? Put your hope in God.” Elijah wanted to die, and God cared for him. Jesus was “a man of sorrows, acquainted with grief,” and in Gethsemane He said, “My soul is consumed with sorrow to the point of death” (Matthew 26:38). Paul wrote of being “hard pressed on all sides.” Depression and anxiety can have many causes, including biology, loss, stress, and trauma. They are not signs of unbelief, and help is available.

> *“Why are you downcast, O my soul? Why the unease within me? Put your hope in God, for I will yet praise Him, my Savior and my God”* (Psalm 42:11).

Also see

> “He was despised and rejected by men, a man of sorrows, acquainted with grief. Like one from whom men hide their faces, He was despised, and we esteemed Him not” (Isaiah 53:3).

> “Then he lay down under the broom tree and fell asleep. Suddenly an angel touched him and said, ‘Get up and eat.’” (1 Kings 19:5).

> “When anxiety overwhelms me, Your consolation delights my soul” (Psalm 94:19).

> “Be anxious for nothing, but in everything, by prayer and petition, with thanksgiving, present your requests to God. And the peace of God, which surpasses all understanding, will guard your hearts and your minds in Christ Jesus” (Philippians 4:6–7).

Common self-statements

- Real Christians are always joyful.
- I am failing God.
- I should be able to pray this away.
- My faith must be weak.
- I should not need help.
- Others will think less of me.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing a Christian is either joyful or faithless.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that I will never be okay.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling low and concluding my faith is false.
- Labeling: Calling myself a bad Christian.

Challenging questions

- Who taught me that Christians do not feel this way?

- Which biblical figures struggled with sadness or fear?
- What does my body and life situation contribute?
- What help have I sought: doctor, counselor, friends, pastor?
- What does Scripture say about God's nearness to the downcast?
- What is one next step?

Truth summary

> Depression and anxiety are not failures of faith. Many faithful people have struggled. God is near, and help through counseling, medical care, and community is part of His provision.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Depression, Symptoms of
- Anxiety/Worry
- Suffering
- Therapy
- Faith

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Divorce
- Forgive/Forgiveness

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Praise You in This Storm — Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham
Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

I Am Not Alone — Kari Jobe
God's companionship remains through darkness, weakness, and uncertainty.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "Christians shouldn't get depressed or anxious"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"Christians shouldn't get depressed or anxious." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Who taught me that Christians do not feel this way?
- ☐ Which biblical figures struggled with sadness or fear?
- ☐ What does my body and life situation contribute?
- ☐ What help have I sought: doctor, counselor, friends, pastor?
- ☐ What does Scripture say about God's nearness to the downcast?
- ☐ What is one next step?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ David was downcast, too.
- ☐ Jesus knew sorrow.
- ☐ God cares for the weary.
- ☐ Struggle is not unbelief.
- ☐ Help is available.
- ☐ I am not alone.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Psalm 42:11
  "Why are you downcast, O my soul? Why the unease within me? Put your hope in God, for I will yet praise Him, my Savior and my God."
- ☐ Isaiah 53:3
  "He was despised and rejected by men, a man of sorrows, acquainted with grief. Like one from whom men hide their faces, He was despised, and we esteemed Him not."
- ☐ 1 Kings 19:5
  "Then he lay down under the broom tree and fell asleep. Suddenly an angel touched him and said, 'Get up and eat.'"

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Help and hope: Each week, note one step of care and one truth.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Psalm 42:11 becomes: "Sarah can write: "David was downcast, and God was near to him.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Depression, Symptoms of" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).

- [ ] Tell someone. Share with a trusted person.
- [ ] See a professional. Doctor or Christian counselor.
- [ ] Read Psalm 42. Pray it as your own.
- [ ] If thoughts of self-harm come, call or text 988 (U.S.). Call 911 in an emergency.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "Christians shouldn't get depressed or anxious": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Help and hope
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~Christians shouldn't get depressed or anxious.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I am weighed down. Meet me in my sadness and fear, send help, and let me know You are near. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

BIOLOGICAL/PHYSICAL FALSE BELIEF #70 · HEALING AND FAITH

“If I'm not healed, I must not be right with God.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

Some equate health with God’s favor and illness with distance from Him. Without healing, we may scour our lives for hidden sin or doubt our salvation.

What Scripture teaches

“Therefore, there is now no condemnation for those who are in Christ Jesus” (Romans 8:1). Right standing with God comes by grace through faith in Christ, not by health. Paul, Timothy, Epaphroditus, and Trophimus were all faithful and all sick at times. “Neither this man nor his parents sinned,” said Jesus of the blind man. Paul’s promise that nothing “will be able to separate us from the love of God that is in Christ Jesus our Lord” includes illness. Health is a blessing, but it is not the proof of God’s favor.

> *“Therefore, there is now no condemnation for those who are in Christ Jesus”* (Romans 8:1).

Also see

> “For I am convinced that neither death nor life, neither angels nor principalities, neither the present nor the future, nor any powers, neither height nor depth, nor anything else in all creation, will be able to separate us from the love of God that is in Christ Jesus our Lord” (Romans 8:38–39).

> “Jesus answered, ‘Neither this man nor his parents sinned, but this happened so that the works of God would be displayed in him.’” (John 9:3).

> “Erastus has remained at Corinth, and Trophimus I left sick in Miletus” (2 Timothy 4:20).

> “For it is by grace you have been saved through faith, and this not from yourselves; it is the gift of God, not by works, so that no one can boast” (Ephesians 2:8–9).

Common self-statements

- Healthy people are in good standing with God.
- I am being passed over.
- I am out of favor.
- Something is blocking me.
- I should be healed if I were right.
- I am under a cloud.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing health shows favor and illness shows disfavor.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that God is displeased.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling sick and concluding that I am not right with God.
- Labeling: Calling myself out of favor.

Challenging questions

- What do I think healing would prove about me?

- What does Scripture say about right standing with God?
- Which faithful people in Scripture were ill?
- What is true of me in Christ?
- What would it mean to rest in grace?
- Who can remind me of God's love?

Truth summary

> My standing with God is secured by Christ, not by my health. Illness does not mean God is displeased. Nothing can separate me from His love.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Grace
- Sickness
- Guilt/Shame
- Suffering
- God, All Loving

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Love
- Divorce

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Praise You in This Storm — Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham
Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

I Am Not Alone — Kari Jobe
God's companionship remains through darkness, weakness, and uncertainty.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

My Plan for Replacing "If I'm not healed, I must not be right with God"

✦ ✦ ✦

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Name: _____ Date started: _____

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Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"If I'm not healed, I must not be right with God." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What do I think healing would prove about me?
- ☐ What does Scripture say about right standing with God?
- ☐ Which faithful people in Scripture were ill?
- ☐ What is true of me in Christ?
- ☐ What would it mean to rest in grace?
- ☐ Who can remind me of God's love?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ There is no condemnation in Christ.
- ☐ Nothing separates me from His love.
- ☐ Faithful people were sick, too.
- ☐ Grace is a gift.
- ☐ Health is not my standing.
- ☐ I rest in Christ.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Romans 8:1
  "Therefore, there is now no condemnation for those who are in Christ Jesus."
- ☐ Romans 8:38–39
  "For I am convinced that neither death nor life, neither angels nor principalities, neither the present nor the future, nor any powers, neither height nor depth, nor anything else in all creation, will be able to separate us from the love of God that is in Christ Jesus our Lord."
- ☐ John 9:3
  "Jesus answered, 'Neither this man nor his parents sinned, but this happened so that the works of God would be displayed in him.'"

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

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  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Secure in Christ: Each week, note one reminder of grace.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Romans 8:1 becomes: "Sarah can write: "There is no condemnation for me in Christ.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Grace" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

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- [ ] Read Romans 8. Underline the promises.
- [ ] Name the fear. Write what you fear is blocking you.
- [ ] Confess if there is sin. Receive forgiveness.
- [ ] Share. Talk to a pastor or counselor.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "If I'm not healed, I must not be right with God": _____ % My truth: _____ %

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My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~If I'm not healed, I must not be right with God.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Father, I fear I am out of favor. Thank You that in Christ there is no condemnation and nothing can separate me from Your love. Amen.

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